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SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Debbie Bigelow, who had been living at Gabriel House, is not sure where she will go when she leaves Fall River HealthCare.

FOR FIRE SURVIVORS, LOSS AND UNCERTAINTY

Gabriel House residents miss friends, possessions — and their home

By Omar Mohammed,

GLOBE STAFF

and Ava Berger and Jessica Ma

GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

FALL RIVER — Michael Pimentel is missing his hearing aid, brand-new glasses, and his lower dentures. None of that, though, compares to the loss of his “family.”

More than a week after Pimentel survived the fire at the Gabriel House assisted living facility that killed 10 of his neighbors, the 72-year-old finds it difficult to adjust to the tragic reality: He talks of some residents who perished as if they are still alive, only to have to remind himself that his “good friends” are truly gone.

A double amputee who uses a motorized scooter to get around, Pimentel is still trying to understand why he survived but others didn’t.

“It was a family, dysfunctional, but a family,” he said.

The 59 survivors are now scattered mostly around the Fall River area and Eastern

‘It was a family, dysfunctional, but a family.’

MIKE PIMENTEL

Gabriel House resident describing the community at the assisted living facility



DAVID L. RYAN/BOSTON GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts: They are in 11 different facilities that provide care or housing for seniors, including one around 60 miles away in South Yarmouth. Several were initially sent to a motel in Dartmouth called Capri Hotel, but have since checked out.

They are all waiting to learn when they can retrieve their belongings — and where they will live next. Many have severe medical needs and more than 75 percent are enrolled in Medicaid and chose Gabriel House because it charged less than a typical facility for private-paying patients.

Kimberly Smith, executive director of United Way of Greater Fall River, said Tuesday all of the displaced residents had been contacted and are in a case management system. Yet, many residents interviewed by the Globe are still uncertain about their future. Some lost most of their possessions, have been unable to get in touch with their families, or don’t have anyone they can turn to for help. They are afraid they’ll wind up

SURVIVOR, Page A10

French President Emmanuel Macron said France will recognize Palestine as a state, a bold diplomatic move amid snowballing global anger over people starving in Gaza. **A5.**



Hulk Hogan has died. His star power helped transform professional wrestling into a multi-billion dollar industry. **C9.**



Chuck Mangione, whose flugelhorn helped create the genre known as “smooth jazz,” has died. He was 84. **C9.**

Fever pitch

Friday: Hot, storm possible. High: 91-96. Low: 68-73.

Saturday: Less humid. High: 77-82. Low: 63-68.

Sunrise: 5:30 Sunset: 8:11

Comics and Weather, **G6-7.**

Obituaries, C9.

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Democrats’ early ’28 target: JD Vance

Even though the election is years off, vice president is already drawing attention

By Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Earlier this month, Vice President JD Vance took his kids to California to see Disneyland. And the state’s Democratic governor, Gavin Newsom, saw an opportunity.

“JD is back in California,” Newsom posted on X, taunting Vance for not accepting his invitation to debate him on the merits of the newly signed Republican policy bill or the Trump administration’s immigration policy.

“Instead, he’s off to Disneyland,” Newsom continued. “Probably to detain Mickey Mouse at this rate.”

In an additional post, Newsom told Vance to “enjoy your family time” as “the families you’re tearing apart certainly won’t.”

“Had a great time, thanks,” the vice president fired back nonchalantly.

The spat encapsulated an emerging dynamic on the national political stage. More and more, high-profile Democrats — especially those who could run for the presidency in 2028

— see Vance as a particularly fitting foil for their broader attacks against President Trump and his Republican Party.

The 40-year old Ohioan is, for now, the most obvious heir apparent to Trump as the GOP standard-bearer in 2028. He is a leading presence on the party’s big money circuit: On Tuesday, he traveled to Nantucket for a GOP fund-raiser, where tickets ran for \$100,000 each.

Vance’s prominence, along with his penchant for picking fights with political rivals, makes him an appealing target to Democratic hopefuls looking to command attention and build their own brands. In other

VANCE, Page A6

‘Slow-moving train wreck’ hitting courts, fired immigration judge says

Widespread judicial dismissals occur even as backlog grows

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio

GLOBE STAFF

George D. Pappas had been bracing for it. A judge in one of the nation’s immigration courts, Pappas watched as, one after the other, colleagues across the country were fired or resigned from their posts.

So he was not surprised when on July 11, he received the notice of his own termination at the end of his two-year probationary period, when most judges are converted to a permanent position.

“We knew that this slow-moving train wreck was going to finally reach us,” Pappas, who served at the immigration court in Chelmsford, said in an interview.

Yet the news hit hard. To Pappas, who had spent more than two decades practicing immigration law, it seemed like more evidence of a startling new reality: The Trump administration was dismantling the immigration court system.

“The toxic environment has corrupted the current immigration court system nationwide, especially in Massachusetts,” Pappas said. “I stayed until the end, because I could do some good while I was on the bench.”

Across the country, more than 100 immigration judges, many appointed by for-

JUDGES, Page A7

Columbia deal gives Harvard a blueprint

Some urge school to stand firm against White House

By Anjali Huynh

GLOBE STAFF

Columbia University’s agreement Wednesday to pay the federal government more than \$220 million was the first big settlement to come out of the war President Trump has waged on higher education in the name of fighting antisemitism.

Now, that deal offers up a potential blueprint for a path to peace for Columbia’s Ivy League rival, Harvard University.

The administration touted the agreement, which was less severe than some higher education observers feared, as a “roadmap for elite universities” seeking to end the onslaught of funding cuts and regulatory challenges.

But it’s unclear whether Harvard will follow suit with its own agreement anytime soon — or that the measures Columbia agreed to are ones Harvard is willing to undertake.

While Harvard has already adopted some of the changes included in Columbia’s agreement, there were other elements — particularly those requiring reporting student information to the government — that prompted Harvard backers to urge the Cambridge school to stand firm. After waging a legal and public relations campaign to defend its in-

COLUMBIA, Page A7

Beacon Hill pressed to solve lawyers’ work stoppage

Court-appointed attorneys asked for raises early in year

By Sean Cotter and Matt Stout

GLOBE STAFF

Court-appointed attorneys who represent indigent criminal defendants first asked the state Legislature for a pay raise as early as February and repeated their requests over the spring before initiating a work stoppage in May in a high-pressure negotiating tactic with lawmakers.

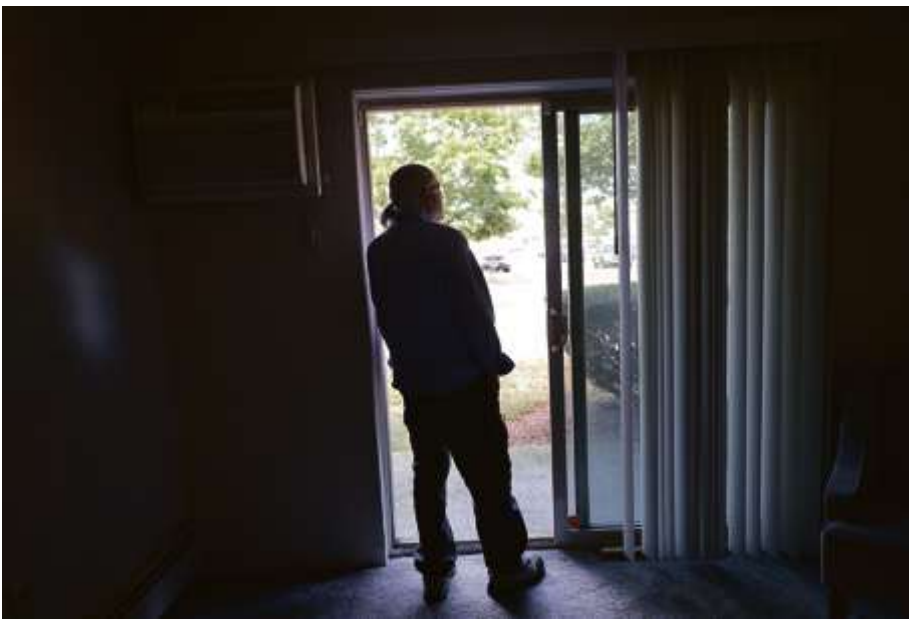
Emails reviewed by the Globe show the attorneys, known as bar advocates, had asked for higher pay multiple times as the Legislature was preparing the annual state budget, only to see several attempts by lawmakers go nowhere. The Globe did not review any responses to those requests.

Legislators who have been critical of the work stoppage contend the lawyers should have come to them sooner instead of triggering a legal crisis that has forced judges to dismiss cases and release defendants.

With August recess looming on Beacon Hill, the months-long stoppage has ratcheted up pressure on lawmakers to resolve the crisis as paralysis grips the state’s court system.

“They should have taken it more seriously,” defense attorney and Suffolk Law professor Chris Dearborn said of the Legislature. “We may be in

BAR ADVOCATES, Page A10



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

George D. Pappas was terminated as an immigration judge on July 11, at the end of his two-year probationary period.